METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Packaging Material & Waste Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Packaging Material & Waste Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Packaging Material & Waste is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their production of or reliance upon packaging materials, their potential exposure to waste management and packaging regulations, as well as their efforts to reduce the environmental impact of packaging materials.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Loss of access to markets due to reform of regulations governing packaging material and waste.
- Loss of revenue due to changing consumer preferences.
- Increased costs to reformulate packaging and comply with producer responsibility regulations.

Packaging Material & Waste Key Issue score

The Packaging Material & Waste Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score on this Key Issue is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Packaging Material & Waste Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Packaging Material & Waste Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Packaging Material & Waste Practices score	Disclosure of packaging material mix
	Scope of consumer programs to reduce waste
	Scope of recycling programs where not mandated by law
	Strategy to reduce the environmental impact of packaging
	Targets related to packaging content
	Targets related to packaging material circularity or waste elimination
Packaging Material & Waste Performance score	Scope of environmental improvements in packaging
	Scope of product or packaging recovery

Packaging Material & Waste Management score

The Packaging Material & Waste Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Packaging Material & Waste Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

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$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Packaging Material & Waste Practices score

The Packaging Material & Waste Practices score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks related to its production of or reliance upon packaging materials, as well as its efforts to reduce the environmental impact of packaging materials. This score is a component of the Packaging Material & Waste Management score (excluding controversies) and considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Disclosure of packaging material mix**

Definition: How transparent the company is about the type of materials used in its packaging. Best practice is full disclosure.

- **Scope of consumer programs to reduce waste**

Definition: The scope of the company's consumer education programs on recycling (e.g., take-back locations) or recycling instructions.

- **Scope of recycling programs where not mandated by law**

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Definition: The extent of the company's involvement in recycling or recovery of packaging materials in locations or circumstances where packaging waste recycling is not mandated by law. Best practice is to have an overarching packaging waste strategy.

- **Strategy to reduce the environmental impact of packaging**

Definition: The comprehensiveness of the company's strategy to reduce the environmental impact of its packaging, such as through waste elimination, packaging redesign, and engagement with suppliers or customers. Best practice is to have specific initiatives that reduce the environmental impact of packaging.

- **Targets related to packaging content**

Definition: Assesses the company's targets and their scope focused on recycled material content of packaging. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Scope of targets to increase recycled material content of packaging**

  Definition: Indicates the scope of a company's target to incorporate postconsumer recycled materials into its packaging.

  - **Targets to increase recycled or renewable material content of packaging**

  Definition: Indicates whether the company has specific targets for improving packaging content, such as increasing recycled content, renewable content, or eliminating problematic or hard-to-recycle plastic content.

- **Targets related to packaging material circularity or waste elimination**

Definition: Assesses the company's targets and their scope focused on packaging material circularity or waste elimination. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Scope of targets for packaging material circularity or waste elimination**

  Definition: Indicates the scope of environmental targets related to material recovery or waste elimination in packaging.

  - **Targets for packaging material circularity or waste elimination**

    - **Definition**: Indicates whether the company has specific targets related to improving product recovery through packaging.

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Packaging Material & Waste Performance score

The Packaging Material & Waste Performance score evaluates the company's performance on packaging material & waste metrics (including achievements on packaging content and product recovery). It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Scope of environmental improvements in packaging**

Definition: Assesses the company's achievements on packaging content (e.g. light-weighted, recycled content).

- **Scope of product or packaging recovery**

Definition: Assesses the company's achievements on product or packaging recovery.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Packaging waste controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Packaging Material & Waste Exposure score

The Packaging Material & Waste Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

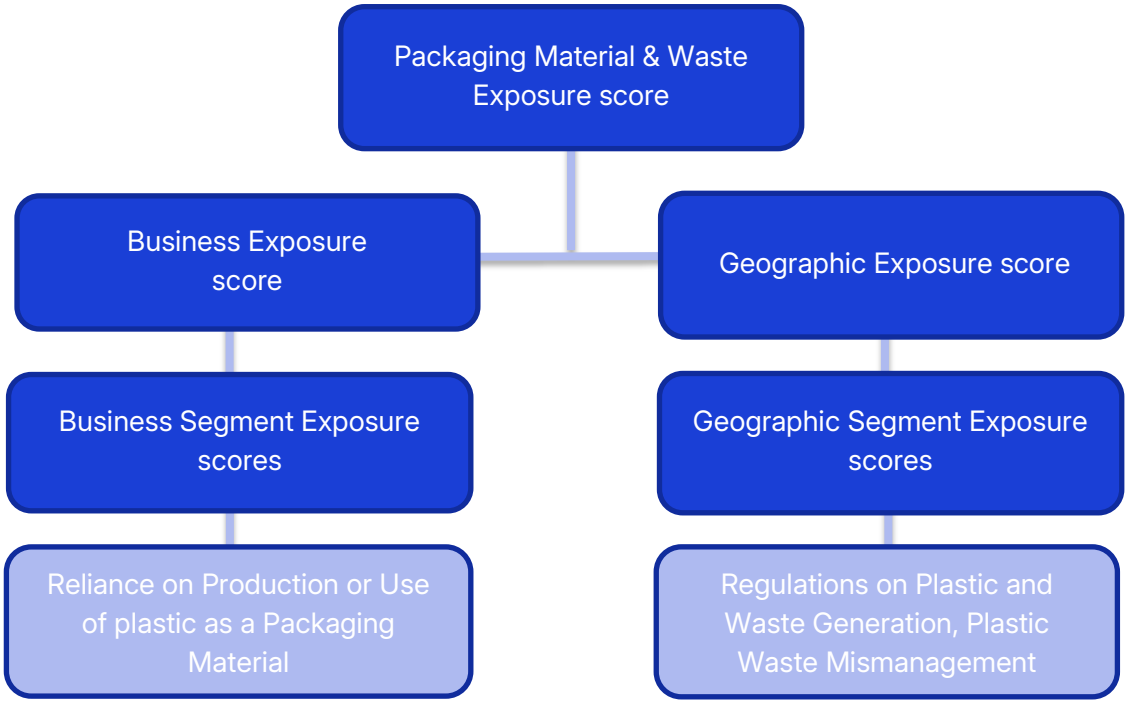
$$EXP_{PMW,i} = BUS_{PMW,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{PMW,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{PMW,i}$ is the Packaging Material & Waste Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{PMW,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $GEO_{PMW,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

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Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{PMW,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{PMW,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{PMW,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

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Business Segment Exposure scores

The Packaging Material and Waste Business Segment Exposure score is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score.

Each business activity score is determined by a simple average of the Plastic Packaging Use and Waste Intensity score and the Plastic Packaging Reliance score.

$$BSE_{PMW,j} = \frac{PPUWS_j + PPRS_j}{2}$$

Where:

- $PPUWS_j$ is the Plastic Packaging Use and Waste Intensity score for business activity j.
- $PPRS_j$ is the Plastic Packaging Reliance score for business activity j.

The Plastic Packaging Use and Waste Intensity score for each business activity is determined by a combined measure of plastic use and plastic waste intensities in metric tons per million euros of economic output in the business activity.

The Plastic Packaging Reliance score for each business activity is determined by a qualitative assessment of whether packaging plays a critical role in the delivery of products and services and whether plastic is a common form of packaging material used.

Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{PMW,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{PMW,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{PMW,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of region r.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of total assets in region r for company i.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments disclosed as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

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$$GSE_{PMW,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{PMW,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{PMW,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

Geographic Segment Exposure scores

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by a simple average of the Recycling Mandates score, the Extended Producer Responsibility score, the Single-use Plastic Law score and the Plastic Waste Mismanagement score:

$$GSE_{PMW,c} = \frac{RM_c + EPR_c + SUP_c + PWM_c}{2}$$

Where:

- RM_c is the Recycling Mandates score in country or market c.
- EPR_c is the Extended Producer Responsibility score in country or market c.
- SUP_c is the Single-use plastics score in country or market c.
- PWM_c is the Plastic Waste Mismanagement score in country or market c.

The Recycling Mandates score is based on a country's recycling mandate policies' stringency and the extent to which the policies are applied within a country or market.

The Extended Producer Responsibility score is based on a country's extended producer responsibility regulations' stringency and the extent to which the policies are applied within a country or market.

The Single-use Plastic Law score is based on a country's single-use plastics regulations' stringency and the extent to which the policies are applied within a country or market.

The Plastic Waste Mismanagement score for each country is based on the quantity of plastic waste generated per capita.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Packaging Material & Waste Exposure score:

"Plastics Policy Inventory," Duke University; United Nations Environment Programme, *Legal Limits on Single-Use Plastics and Microplastics: A Global Review of National Laws and Regulations*; "What A Waste Global Database," World Bank; Cimpan, C., Bjelle, E.L., and Strømman, A.H., "Plastic packaging flows in Europe: A hybrid input-output approach," *Journal of Industrial Ecology* 25, no. 6: 1572-1587; World Development Indicators, World Bank; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; and company disclosures.

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